

IELTS WORKSHOP

THE FORUM CENTER - NGUYỄN HOÀNG HUY

TÀI LIỆU CHUYÊN ĐỀ READING

Level 1 — W7 (Feb 9-15)

Mungo Man

A

Fifty thousand years ago, a lush landscape greeted the first Australians making their way towards the south-east of the continent. Temperatures were cooler than now. Megafauna – giant prehistoric animals such as marsupial lions, goannas and the rhinoceros-sized diprotodon – were abundant. The Lake Mungo remains are three prominent sets of fossils which tell the archeologists the story: Mungo Man lived around the shores of Lake Mungo with his family. When he was young Mungo Man lost his two lower canine teeth, possibly knocked out in a ritual. He grew into a man nearly 1.7m in height. Over the years his molar teeth became worn and scratched, possibly from eating a gritty diet or stripping the long leaves of water reeds with his teeth to make twine. As Mungo Man grew older his bones ached with arthritis, especially his right elbow, which was so damaged that bits of bone were completely worn out or broken away. Such wear and tear are typical of people who have used a woomera to throw spears over many years. Mungo Man reached a good age for the hard life of a hunter-gatherer and died when he was about 50. His family mourned for him, and carefully buried him in the lunette, on his back with his hands crossed in his lap, and sprinkled with red ochre. Mungo Man is the oldest known example in the world of such a ritual.

B

This treasure-trove of history was found by the University of Melbourne geologist Professor Jim Bowler in 1969. He was searching for ancient lakes and came across the charred remains of Mungo Lady, who had been cremated. And in 1974, he found a second complete skeleton, Mungo Man, buried 300 metres away. Using carbon-dating, a technique only reliable to around 40,000 years old, the skeleton was first estimated at 28,000 to 32,000 years old. The comprehensive study of 25 different sediment layers at Mungo concludes that both graves are 40,000 years old.

C

This is much younger than the 62,000 years Mungo Man was attributed within 1999 by a team led by Professor Alan Thorne, of the Australian National University. The modern-day story of the science of Mungo also has its fair share of rivalry. Because Thorne is the country's leading opponent of the Out of Africa theory – that Homo sapiens had a single place of origin. “Dr Alan Thorne supports the multi-regional explanation (that modern humans arose simultaneously in Africa, Europe and Asia from one of our predecessors, Homo erectus, who left Africa more than 1.5 million years ago.) if Mungo Man was descended from a person who had left Africa in the past 200,000 years, Thorne argues, then his mitochondrial DNA should have looked like that of the other samples.”

D

However, Out of Africa supporters are not about to let go of their beliefs because of the Australian research, Professor Chris Stringer, from the Natural History Museum in London, UK, said that the research community would want to see the work repeated in other labs before major

conclusions were drawn from the Australian research. But even assuming the DNA sequences were correct, Professor Stringer said it could just mean that there was much more genetic diversity in the past than was previously realised. There is no evidence here that the ancestry of these Australian fossils goes back a million or two million years. It's much more likely that modern humans came out of Africa." For Bowler, these debates are irritating speculative distractions from the study's main findings. At 40,000 years old, Mungo Man and Mungo Lady remain Australia's oldest human burials and the earliest evidence on Earth of cultural sophistication, he says. Modern humans had not even reached North America by this time. In 1997, Piddo's research group recovered an mtDNA fingerprint from the Feldhofer Neanderthal skeleton uncovered in Germany in 1865 – the first Neanderthal remains ever found.

E

In its 1999 study, Thorne's team used three techniques to date Mungo Man at 62,000 years old, and it stands by its figures. It dated bone, teeth enamel and some sand. Bowler has strongly challenged the results ever since. Dating human bones is "notoriously unreliable", he says. As well, the sand sample Thorne's group dated was taken hundreds of metres from the burial site. "You don't have to be a gravedigger ... to realize the age of the sand is not the same as the age of the grave," says Bowler.

F

Thorne counters that Bowler's team used one dating technique, while he used three. The best practice is to have at least two methods produce the same result. A Thorne team member, Professor Rainer Grün, says the fact that the latest results were consistent between laboratories doesn't mean they are absolutely correct. We now have two data sets that are contradictory. I do not have a plausible explanation." Now, however, Thorne says the age of Mungo Man is irrelevant to this origins debate. Recent fossils find show modern humans were in China 110,000 years ago. "So he has got a long time to turn up in Australia. It doesn't matter if he is 40,000 or 60,000 years old.

G

Dr Tim Flannery, a proponent of the controversial theory that Australia's megafauna were wiped out 46,000 years ago in a "blitzkrieg" of hunting by the arriving people, also claims the new Mungo dates support this view. In 2001 a member of Bowler's team, Dr Richard Roberts of Wollongong University, along with Flannery, director of the South Australian Museum, published research on their blitzkrieg theory. They dated 28 sites across the continent, arguing their analysis showed the megafauna died out suddenly 46,000 years ago. Flannery praises the Bowler team's research on Mungo Man as "the most thorough and rigorous dating" of ancient human remains. He says the finding that humans arrived at Lake Mungo between 46,000 and 50,000 years ago was a critical time in Australia's history. There is no evidence of a dramatic climatic change then, he says. "It's my view that humans arrived and extinction took place in almost the same geological instant."

H

Bowler, however, is skeptical of Flannery's theory and says the Mungo study provides no definitive new evidence to support it. He argues that climate change at 40,000 years ago was more intense than had been previously realized and could have played a role in the megafauna's demise. "To blame the earliest Australians for their complete extinction is drawing a longbow."

Questions 1-8

Use the information in the passage to match the people (listed A-F) with opinions or deeds below.

Write the appropriate letters A-F in boxes 1-8 on your answer sheet.

NB You may use any letter more than once.

A Jim Bowler

B Alan Thorne

C Pddbo

D Tim Flannery

E Chris Stringer

F Rainer Grün

1 He was searching for ancient lakes and came across the charred remains of Mungo Lady, who had been cremated.

2 Professor who hold a skeptical attitude towards reliability for DNA analysis on some fossils.

3 Professor whose determination of the age of Mungo Man to be much younger than the former result which is older than the 62,000 years.

4 determining the age of Mungo Man has little to do with controversy for the origins of Australians.

5 research group who recovered a biological proof of the first Neanderthal found in Europe.

6 a supporter of the idea that Australia's megafauna was extinct due to the hunting by the ancient human beings.

7 Instead of keep arguing a single source origin, multi-regional explanation has been raised.

8 Climate change rather than prehistoric human activities resulted in megafauna's extinction.

Questions 9-14

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

In boxes 9-14 on your answer sheet, write

TRUE if the statement is true

FALSE if the statement is false

NOT GIVEN if the information is not given in the passage

9 The Lake Mungo remains offer the archeologists the evidence of graphic illustration of human activities around.

10 In Lake Mungo remains, weapons were found used by the Mungo.

11 Mungo Man is one of the oldest known archeological evidence in the world of cultural sophistication such as a burying ritual.

12 Mungo Man and woman's skeletons were uncovered in the same year.

13 There is controversy among scientists about the origin of the oldest Homo sapiens.

14 Out of Africa supporters have criticised Australian professors for using an outmoded research method.

Hướng dẫn giải

Phần I: Câu hỏi 1-8 (Matching Features)

Mục tiêu: Nối tên các nhà khoa học (A-F) với các ý kiến hoặc hành động tương ứng của họ được mô tả trong bài.

1. Chiến lược tiếp cận

- Bước 1: Gạch chân tên riêng (A-F) trong bài đọc để định vị vị trí xuất hiện của từng người.
- Bước 2: Đọc các câu hỏi từ 1-8, xác định từ khóa (keywords) chỉ hành động hoặc quan điểm.
- Bước 3: Đối chiếu từ khóa trong câu hỏi với thông tin xung quanh tên người trong bài đọc để tìm đáp án.

2. Phân tích chi tiết từng câu hỏi

- Câu 1: He was searching for ancient lakes and came across the charred remains of Mungo Lady, who had been cremated.
 - Từ khóa: "searching for ancient lakes", "charred remains", "Mungo Lady".
 - Định vị: Đoạn B, câu đầu tiên: "This treasure-trove of history was found by the University of Melbourne geologist Professor Jim Bowler... He was searching for ancient lakes and came across the charred remains of Mungo Lady..."
 - Đối chiếu: Thông tin hoàn toàn trùng khớp với hành động của Jim Bowler.
 - Đáp án: A
- Câu 2: Professor who hold a skeptical attitude towards reliability for DNA analysis on some fossils.
 - Từ khóa: "skeptical attitude", "reliability", "DNA analysis".
 - Định vị: Đoạn D. Chris Stringer nói rằng cộng đồng nghiên cứu muốn thấy công việc được lặp lại và "even assuming the DNA sequences were correct..."(ngay cả khi giả sử trình tự DNA là đúng...).
 - Đối chiếu: Việc đặt giả thiết và yêu cầu lặp lại thí nghiệm thể hiện thái độ hoài nghi (skeptical) về kết quả phân tích DNA của nghiên cứu tại Úc.
 - Đáp án: E
- Câu 3: Professor whose determination of the age of Mungo Man to be much younger than the former result which is older than the 62,000 years.
 - Từ khóa: "age of Mungo Man", "much younger", "former result", "older than 62,000".

- Định vị: Đoạn B và C. Đoạn B nói Jim Bowler kết luận "graves are 40,000 years old". Đoạn C so sánh: "This is much younger than the 62,000 years Mungo Man was attributed... by... Alan Thorne".
 - Đối chiếu: Người đưa ra kết quả trẻ hơn (40,000 năm) so với kết quả cũ (62,000 năm) là Jim Bowler.
 - Đáp án: A
- Câu 4: determining the age of Mungo Man has little to do with controversy for the origins of Australians.
 - Từ khóa: "determining age", "little to do with controversy", "origins".
 - Định vị: Đoạn F, phần cuối: "Now, however, Thorne says the age of Mungo Man is irrelevant to this origins debate."
 - Đối chiếu: "Irrelevant"(không liên quan) đồng nghĩa với "little to do with".
 - Đáp án: B
- Câu 5: research group who recovered a biological proof of the first Neanderthal found in Europe.
 - Từ khóa: "research group", "recovered biological proof", "first Neanderthal", "Europe".
 - Định vị: Đoạn D, câu cuối cùng: "In 1997, Pddbo's research group recovered an mtDNA fingerprint from the Feldhofer Neanderthal skeleton uncovered in Germany..."
 - Đối chiếu: "mtDNA fingerprint" là bằng chứng sinh học, "Germany" thuộc Châu Âu.
 - Đáp án: C
- Câu 6: a supporter of the idea that Australia's megafauna was extinct due to the hunting by the ancient human beings.
 - Từ khóa: "supporter", "megafauna extinct", "hunting", "ancient human beings".
 - Định vị: Đoạn G, câu đầu tiên: "Dr Tim Flannery, a proponent of the controversial theory that Australia's megafauna were wiped out... in a 'blitzkrieg' of hunting..."
 - Đối chiếu: "Proponent" đồng nghĩa với "supporter". Lý thuyết "blitzkrieg of hunting" tương ứng với việc săn bắn dẫn đến tuyệt chủng.
 - Đáp án: D
- Câu 7: Instead of keep arguing a single source origin, multi-regional explanation has been raised.
 - Từ khóa: "single source origin", "multi-regional explanation".
 - Định vị: Đoạn C: "Dr Alan Thorne supports the multi-regional explanation..."
 - Đối chiếu: Alan Thorne ủng hộ thuyết đa vùng thay vì nguồn gốc đơn lẻ (Out of Africa).
 - Đáp án: B
- Câu 8: Climate change rather than prehistoric human activities resulted in megafauna's extinction.
 - Từ khóa: "Climate change", "prehistoric human activities", "megafauna's extinction".
 - Định vị: Đoạn H: "Bowler... argues that climate change at 40,000 years ago... could have played a role in the megafauna's demise."

- Đối chiếu: Bowler cho rằng biến đổi khí hậu là nguyên nhân chính, phản bác lại lý thuyết săn bắn của con người.
- Đáp án: A

Phần II: Câu hỏi 9-14 (True/False/Not Given)

Mục tiêu: Xác định độ chính xác của thông tin dựa trên bài đọc.

1. Chiến lược tiếp cận

- Bước 1: Phân tích câu hỏi để tìm từ khóa định vị (keywords).
- Bước 2: Tìm đoạn văn chứa từ khóa.
- Bước 3: So sánh ý nghĩa giữa câu hỏi và bài đọc.

2. Phân tích chi tiết từng câu hỏi

- Câu 9: The Lake Mungo remains offer the archeologists the evidence of graphic illustration of human activities around.
 - Từ khóa: "Lake Mungo remains", "evidence", "graphic illustration", "human activities".
 - Phân tích: Đoạn A mô tả chi tiết cuộc đời Mungo Man dựa trên hóa thạch: "lost his two lower canine teeth", "stripping the long leaves... to make twine", "used a woomera to throw spears".
 - Đối chiếu: Các chi tiết cụ thể này chính là minh họa sinh động (graphic illustration) cho các hoạt động của con người thời đó.
 - Kết luận: Thông tin trùng khớp.
 - Đáp án: TRUE
- Câu 10: In Lake Mungo remains, weapons were found used by the Mungo.
 - Từ khóa: "weapons", "found", "used by Mungo".
 - Phân tích: Đoạn A có nhắc đến "woomera to throw spears" (dụng cụ phóng lao), nhưng là do suy luận từ vết thương trên xương khuỷu tay ("wear and tear are typical of people who have used a woomera").
 - Đối chiếu: Bài đọc không hề nói rằng vũ khí thực sự được tìm thấy (found) tại hiện trường, chỉ có xương người được tìm thấy.
 - Kết luận: Không có thông tin về việc tìm thấy vũ khí.
 - Đáp án: NOT GIVEN
- Câu 11: Mungo Man is one of the oldest known archeological evidence in the world of cultural sophistication such as a burying ritual.
 - Từ khóa: "Mungo Man", "oldest known archeological evidence", "cultural sophistication", "burying ritual".

- Phân tích: Cuối đoạn A: "Mungo Man is the oldest known example in the world of such a ritual."Đoạn D: "earliest evidence on Earth of cultural sophistication".
 - Đối chiếu: Thông tin hoàn toàn trùng khớp.
 - Kết luận: Thông tin đúng.
 - Đáp án: TRUE
- Câu 12: Mungo Man and woman's skeletons were uncovered in the same year.
 - Từ khóa: "Mungo Man and woman's skeletons", "uncovered", "same year".
 - Phân tích: Đoạn B cho biết Mungo Lady được tìm thấy năm 1969, còn Mungo Man được tìm thấy năm 1974.
 - Đối chiếu: Hai mốc thời gian khác nhau (1969 so với 1974).
 - Kết luận: Thông tin sai lệch.
 - Đáp án: FALSE
- Câu 13: There is controversy among scientists about the origin of the oldest Homo sapiens.
 - Từ khóa: "controversy", "scientists", "origin of oldest Homo sapiens".
 - Phân tích: Đoạn C nhắc đến "rivalry"(sự cạnh tranh/tranh cãi) và sự đối lập giữa thuyết "Out of Africa" và "multi-regional explanation".
 - Đối chiếu: Sự cạnh tranh giữa các lý thuyết về nguồn gốc con người chính là sự tranh cãi (controversy).
 - Kết luận: Thông tin trùng khớp.
 - Đáp án: TRUE
- Câu 14: Out of Africa supporters have criticised Australian professors for using an outmoded research method.
 - Từ khóa: "Out of Africa supporters", "criticised", "Australian professors", "outmoded research method".
 - Phân tích: Đoạn D nói Chris Stringer (người ủng hộ Out of Africa) muốn thấy nghiên cứu được lặp lại và nghi ngờ kết quả DNA. Tuy nhiên, ông không chỉ trích phương pháp nghiên cứu là "outmoded"(lỗi thời).
 - Đối chiếu: Bài đọc có nhắc đến việc Bowler chỉ trích việc định tuổi xương là "unreliable"(không đáng tin), nhưng không có thông tin về việc nhóm Out of Africa chê phương pháp của Úc là lỗi thời.
 - Kết luận: Không tìm thấy thông tin này.
 - Đáp án: NOT GIVEN